

Eden M. Melles

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science
Northwestern University

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Research Interests

Race and Ethnicity; Migration; Political Behavior; Mixed Methods.

Education

Northwestern University

September 2021–Present

Ph.D. in Political Science

Major Field: American Politics

Minor Field: Methodology

Affiliate of: Program for African Studies

& Middle East and North African Studies Program

Northwestern University

December 2023

M.A. in Political Science

Lipscomb University

August 2017–December 2020

B.A. in Political Science

Minor in History and Religion

Research

Dissertation: “Borders Beyond Borders: Migration, Identity, and the Transnational Political Behavior of the Eritrean Diaspora”

Committee: Reuel Rogers, Nazita Lajevardi, Tabitha Bonilla

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Bonilla, Tabitha, Nazita Lajevardi, and Eden Melles. “Intergroup Solidarity: White and Black Responses to Criticism and Support for Palestine.” *PS: Political Science & Politics*. Forthcoming, 2026.

Bonilla, Tabitha, and Eden Melles. “Examining Religious and Racial Identity for Black Christians and Muslims in the United States.” *The Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics*, 2026. DOI.

Working Papers

Melles, Eden. “Black and Ethnic: Theorizing Approaches to the Study of Black Immigrants in the United States.”

Melles, Eden, and Kumar Ramanathan. “Investigating the Naturalization Gap: Determinants of Immigrant Political Participation in the US.”

Conference Presentations & Invited Talks

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting

“Black and Ethnic: Theorizing Approaches to the Study of Black Immigrants in the United States” 2026

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting

“Black and Ethnic: Theorizing Approaches to the Study of Black Immigrants in the United States” 2026

Program for Middle East and North African Studies, Northwestern University

“Sudan’s Current Civil War Two Years On: Perspectives and Prospects” 2025

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting

“Intergroup Solidarity: White and Black Evaluations of Israel and Palestine” 2024

Politics of Race, Immigration, and Ethnicity Consortium, Ohio State University

“How Religious Identity Reinforces Racial Identity for Black Muslims & Christians” 2024

Anti-Muslim Discrimination APSA Panel (reconvened)

“How Religious Identity Reinforces Racial Identity for Black Muslims & Christians” 2024

Program for Middle East and North African Studies, Northwestern University

“Understanding the Struggle for Sudan” 2024

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting

“How Religious Identity Reinforces Racial Identity for Black Muslims & Christians” 2024

Race and Capitalism in the Twenty-First Century: An Interdisciplinary and Community-Engaged Workshop, Princeton University

“Workshop Presentation” 2024

17th Annual Muslim Studies Program Conference, Michigan State University

“How Religious Identity Reinforces Racial Identity for Black Muslims & Christians” 2024

American Politics Workshop, Northwestern University

“Outsiders Amongst Their Own: Exploring Perceived Racial & Ethnic Discrimination and Constructions of Identity Amongst Black American & Foreign-Born Muslims” 2024

Research Experience

Community Manager,

The Organizing Forum Research Group

September 2024–Present

Dr. Dan Galvin, Dr. Hahrie Han, Dr. Deva Woodly, Dr. Ray Block

Graduate Research Assistant,

Buffett Institute for Global Affairs

November 2024–June 2025

Northwestern Language Departments

Northwestern University

Research Assistant,

Institute for Policy Research

Spring 2024, Summer 2024, Fall 2025

Dr. Tabitha Bonilla, Dr. Brian Libgober

Northwestern University

Research Assistant,

Department of Political Science

Winter 2022, Spring 2022, Summer 2022

PIs: Dr. Julie Merseth & Dr. Michael Rodríguez-Muñiz

Northwestern University

Junior Consultant and Data Analyst

September 2020–August 2021

Advisory83

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, African American Politics

Winter 2023

Northwestern University

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to American Politics

Fall 2022

Northwestern University

Awards, Grants, and Fellowships

Minar Award

2026

Northwestern University Department of Political Science

Amount: \$1,000

Institute for Qualitative and Multi-methods Research Scholarship

2026

Northwestern University Department of Political Science

Edward Alexander Bouchet Graduate Honor Society

2025

Northwestern University Graduate School

Dissertation Development Program

2024

Northwestern University Graduate School

Amount: \$4,000

Diversity Fellowship Research Grant

2023

American Political Science Association

Amount: \$500

Graduate Research Fellowship Program

2024

National Science Foundation

Amount: \$37,000 and full tuition

Diversity Fellowship

2024

American Political Science Association

Amount: \$5,000

Professional Service

American Politics Workshop Coordinator

2026–Present

Department of Political Science, Northwestern University

Regional Conference Team

2026–Present

Women of Color in Political Science

Edward Alexander Bouchet Honor Society Selection Committee

2026

The Graduate School, Northwestern University

Race and Ethnicity Politics Workshop Coordinator

2022–2025

Department of Political Science, Northwestern University

Graduate Student Representative

2023–2024

Department of Political Science, Northwestern University

Graduate School Peer Mentor

2023–2024

The Graduate School, Northwestern University

Teaching Committee

2023–2024

Department of Political Science, Northwestern University

Diversity Recruiter & Graduate Admissions Representative

2022–2025

Department of Political Science, Northwestern University

Reviewer

Sociology of Race and Ethnicity; Politics, Groups, and Identities

Methods, Skills, and Training

Statistical Software: R, Stata, SPSS

Programming and Research Tools: R Markdown, Quarto, L^AT_EX

Methods Training: Institute for Qualitative and Multi-methods Research

Languages: Tigrinya, Arabic

Last updated: September 2026